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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

SUNDAY, 25 OCTOBER 2026

19 must-know stories, 28 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 522 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

The Frontier Nagaland Territorial Authority (FNTA) Bill, 2026

President Droupadi Murmu has given her assent to the Frontier Nagaland Territorial Authority (FNTA) Bill 2026. The Bill was unanimously passed by the Nagaland Legislative Assembly on September 3, 2026. Nagaland Chief Minister Neiphiu Rio announced the presidential assent through a post on the social media platform X. The Chief Minister thanked the President and expressed gratitude to the Union Home Ministry for coordinating the legislative process. This development is viewed as a significant step towards fulfilling the developmental and regional aspirations of the people of Eastern Nagaland.

When: September 3, 2026 · **Where:** Nagaland · **Who:** President Droupadi Murmu, Chief Minister Neiphiu Rio, Union Home Ministry · **Prelims:** The Frontier Nagaland Territorial Authority (FNTA) Bill was passed in 2026.; The Bill was unanimously passed by the Nagaland Legislative Assembly on September 3, 2026.; President Droupadi Murmu gave assent to the legislation.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Marks a crucial constitutional and administrative step for the governance of Eastern Nagaland.; Reflects coordination between the state government and the Union Home Ministry to address regional demands.*

Static — Article 371A of the Indian Constitution makes special provisions for Nagaland, restricting Parliament's power to legislate on Naga religious or social practices, customary law, and land ownership without the state assembly's concurrence. Autonomous District Councils in Northeast India are generally established under the Sixth Schedule of the Constitution to provide self-governance and protect tribal populations. Eastern Nagaland comprises specific backward districts of the state where local bodies and groups have historically agitated for greater administrative autonomy and separate administrative arrangements due to perceived developmental neglect.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

Hindustan Times: read the source · free copy on newsonair.gov.in

GS2 MAKE NOTES

DoPT outlines implementation challenges arising from SC judgment on OBC creamy layer criteria

The Department of Personnel and Training examined implementation challenges stemming from the Supreme Court judgment dated 11 March 2026 concerning OBC creamy layer criteria. The review covered implications for service and cadre allocation, existing seniority and gradation, past recruitments, and the nationwide implementation of the OBC reservation policy. The Supreme Court judgment dismissed Union of India appeals and ordered creating supernumerary posts for respondents and intervenors within six months. The DoPT filed a Miscellaneous Application before the Supreme Court on 24 August 2026 seeking clarification and directions regarding the judgment. Consultations were held with the UPSC, Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, and Ministry of Law and Justice, collating data across fourteen Civil Services Examination years. The Department noted the absence of a demonstrable criterion like salary for identifying creamy layers among candidates whose parents work outside government service. Concerns were raised that implementation could impact past recruitments, trigger retrospective service allocations, and disrupt existing seniority and gradation of officers. The DoPT stated that the delay in starting the Foundation Course for CSE-2025 candidates will not affect their service conditions or seniority.

When: 24 August 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT), Supreme Court of India, UPSC, Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Ministry of Law and Justice · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court judgment order date is 11 March 2026 (2026 INSC 230).; The DoPT filed a Miscellaneous Application before the Supreme Court on 24 August 2026.; The final result of CSE-2025 was declared on 6 March 2026.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the complex interface between judicial rulings on affirmative action and executive implementation hurdles.; Exposes systemic administrative challenges involving service seniority, retrospective cadre changes, and multi-year recruitment adjustments.*

Static — The creamy layer concept excludes economically better-off individuals among Other Backward Classes from reservation benefits, originally mandated following the Indira Sawhney judgment. Article 14 of the Constitution guarantees equality before law and equal protection of the laws, serving as a benchmark against arbitrary classification. The Department of Personnel and Training is the nodal agency of the Central

Government for personnel matters, policy formulation, and administrative training.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Judgment

thestatesman.com: read the source · also reported by ETLegalWorld.com

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Reaffirms Chief Justice as Master of the Roster; Quashes High Court Order in GRSE Compassionate Appointment Dispute

A legal dispute regarding compassionate appointments at GRSE led to a challenge in the Supreme Court over bench allocation and judicial propriety. The Supreme Court quashed a High Court order in a Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers compassionate appointment dispute and reaffirmed the Chief Justice's role as the master of the roster.

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India, Calcutta High Court, Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE) · **Prelims:** The case involved Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE).; The Supreme Court quashed a High Court order.; The ruling reaffirmed the Chief Justice as the master of the roster.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces institutional discipline and administrative hierarchy within the Indian judiciary.; Prevents arbitrary bench hunting and ensures transparent case allocation.*

Static — The Chief Justice of India and Chief Justices of High Courts act as the master of the roster, exercising exclusive administrative power to constitute benches and allocate cases. This administrative authority is rooted in the need for institutional order and prevents forum shopping or arbitrary bench hunting by litigants. The Supreme Court has repeatedly affirmed this principle in landmark judgments, including Campaign for Judicial Accountability and Judicial Reforms v. Union of India (2018) and Shanti Bhushan v. Supreme Court (2018).

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Appointment

TaxCorp AI: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

No EC nod needed for voter to sue candidate over false information: Supreme Court

The Supreme Court ruled that a private person or voter can file a criminal complaint against an election candidate for furnishing false information in an affidavit. The court held that prior approval or a complaint from the Election Commission is not required to initiate such proceedings under Section 125-A of the Representation of People Act. The core issue involved interpreting the interplay between Section 125-A of the RP Act and Section 195(1) of the CrPC regarding cognizance of offences. A bench comprising Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu set aside a contrary order passed by the Karnataka High Court. The apex court observed that Section 125-A was inserted in the RP Act in 2002 and was deliberately omitted from Section 195 of the CrPC during its 2006 amendment. The court rejected the Election Commission's press note claiming exclusive authority to take cognizance and refer such matters, stating executive guidelines do not bind judicial interpretation. Addressing fears of misuse by political rivals, the Supreme Court noted that magistrates are adequately empowered under existing laws to handle frivolous or harassing complaints.

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu · **Prelims:** Section 125-A of the Representation of People Act penalizes filing false affidavits with up to six months of imprisonment.; Section 125-A was inserted into the RP Act in the year 2002.; Section 195 of the CrPC deals with prosecution for contempt of lawful authority of public servants and offences against public justice.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Empowers voters to directly hold election candidates accountable for concealing or falsifying information in affidavits.; Clarifies the statutory boundary between the Representation of People Act and the Code of Criminal Procedure.*

Static — The Representation of the People Act, 1951 is an act of Parliament of India to regulate the conduct of elections and to specify the qualification and disqualification for membership of the houses. Section 125-A of the RP Act penalizes candidates for failing to furnish information, or giving false information or concealment of information in nomination affidavits. Section 195 of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC) bars courts from taking cognizance of certain offences against public servants or contempt of lawful authority unless a written complaint is made by the public servant concerned.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Times of India: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Ladakh Governance Crisis: Statehood and Sixth Schedule

The Centre took two steps in the Union Territory of Ladakh: an MHA sub-committee shared a 32-page draft proposal with civil society leaders, and the LG administration announced Sankoo as Ladakh's eighth district. These moves address Ladakh's persistent demands for Statehood, Sixth Schedule inclusion, land protection, and employment safeguards following its creation as a UT in 2019. The Leh Apex Body (LAB) and Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) jointly rejected the draft proposal in principle, citing departures from earlier commitments and the lack of a legislative assembly. The rejected draft offered no constitutional safeguards under Article 371 tailored to Ladakh and urged the MHA to accept their own submitted MoU instead. Internal friction exists as the Civil Society Forum of Ladakh, led by former MP Thupstan Chhewang, welcomed the MHA's roadmap. The MHA constituted a High-Powered Committee in 2023 under MoS Home Affairs Nityanand Rai to protect culture, land, employment, and empower LAHDCs. May 2026 talks produced commitments for a customised governance model with legislative powers and Article 371 safeguards, but the October draft resembled a Territorial Council model.

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** Ladakh · **Who:** Leh Apex Body (LAB), Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA), Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), Lieutenant Governor's administration · **Prelims:** Ladakh was carved out as a Union Territory in 2019.; Sankoo was announced as Ladakh's eighth district.; The High-Powered Committee of 2023 is chaired by MoS Home Affairs Nityanand Rai.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the ongoing political friction between regional civil society groups and the central government regarding governance autonomy in strategic border regions.; Examines the tension between administrative decentralisation through new districts and political empowerment via a full legislature.*

Static — The Sixth Schedule of the Constitution provides for the administration of tribal areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram through Autonomous District Councils (ADCs). Article 371 of the Constitution contains special provisions for various states and regions to protect their unique cultural and economic interests. Ladakh was carved out as a separate Union Territory without a legislature from Jammu and Kashmir on October 31, 2019.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Internal Security

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Upholds Constitutional Validity of Amendments to Ninth Schedule — Clarifies Scope of Judicial Review.

The judgment was issued in response to legal challenges concerning legislative amendments added to the Ninth Schedule. The Supreme Court upheld the constitutional validity of amendments to the Ninth Schedule and clarified the scope of judicial review.

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court of India

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reaffirms the supremacy of the Constitution and the basic structure doctrine over unbridled legislative immunity.; Balances the state's power to implement socio-economic welfare laws with the protection of fundamental rights.*

Static — The Ninth Schedule was added to the Constitution by the First Amendment Act of 1951 to protect land reform laws from judicial review. Article 31B shields laws included in the Ninth Schedule from being declared void on the ground of inconsistency with fundamental rights. In the landmark Kesavananda Bharati case (1973), the Supreme Court propounded the Basic Structure Doctrine.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Lawtext: read the source · also reported by The Hindu, The Daily Star

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Upholds Right to Religious Freedom Against Compulsion to Sing National Anthem. Expulsion of Students for Refusing to Sing National Anthem Violates Fundamental Rights Under Articles 19(1)(a) and 25(1) of the Constitution.

The Supreme Court delivered a landmark ruling protecting religious freedom and the right to remain silent against compulsory national anthem singing. The Supreme Court ruled that expelling students for refusing to sing the national anthem violates fundamental rights under Articles 19(1)(a) and 25(1).

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** Article 19(1)(a) guarantees freedom of speech and expression.; Article 25(1) guarantees freedom of religion and conscience.; The case involved the expulsion of students for refusing to sing the national anthem.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Upholds constitutional protection for minority religious beliefs and practices.; Reinforces the principle that freedom of expression includes the right to remain silent.*

Static — Article 19(1)(a) of the Indian Constitution guarantees freedom of speech and expression to all citizens, subject to reasonable restrictions under Article 19(2). Article 25(1) guarantees freedom of conscience and the right freely to profess, practice, and propagate religion, subject to public order, morality, and health. Fundamental Rights are enforceable against the State under Part III of the Constitution, ensuring protection of individual liberties against state action.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Lawtext: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Dismisses Writ Petition Challenging Extension of Director of Enforcement's Tenure — Upholds Government's Authority to Extend Tenure Beyond Two Years.

The Supreme Court delivered its verdict dismissing the writ petition challenging the tenure extension. The Supreme Court dismissed a writ petition that challenged the government's authority to extend the tenure of the Director of Enforcement beyond two years, upholding the extension.

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court, Director of Enforcement · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court dismissed a writ petition challenging the extension of the Director of Enforcement's tenure.; The court upheld the government's authority to extend the tenure beyond two years.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Clarifies the extent of executive discretion in determining the tenure of premier investigating agency heads.; Addresses crucial questions regarding the institutional autonomy and accountability of the Enforcement Directorate.*

Static — The Enforcement Directorate (ED) functions as a premier financial investigation agency under the Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance, Government of India. It enforces the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA), and the Fugitive Economic Offenders Act. The Director of Enforcement's appointment and tenure are governed by statutory provisions under the

Central Vigilance Commission (CVC) Act and related ordinances.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Lawtext: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Fantasy to imagine collegium isolated from political pressure: Ex-SC judge Sanjay Kaul; flags Centre's NJAC resentment

Former Supreme Court judge Sanjay Kishan Kaul writes in his memoir that the collegium has never been insulated from political pressures. He argues that the government's lingering resentment over the striking down of the NJAC in 2015 shapes its dealings with the judiciary. Justice Kaul highlights the dangerous shift from consultation to pre-approval, where the executive's nod is sought before formal collegium deliberation. He criticizes former CJI Dhananjaya Y Chandrachud for being too deferential and managing the executive relationship individually rather than collectively. Justice Kaul recounts an incident where the government questioned a minority candidate's elevation based on community representation and ancestral caste conversion. He walked out of a collegium meeting over these irrelevant queries, after which the government eventually relented and the candidate was cleared. Justice Kaul successfully pushed for a reform where soft copies of candidate judgments and disposal records are circulated before discussions. Former CJI Chandrachud responded that official records show all collegium resolutions were unanimous and Justice Kaul never recorded a formal dissent.

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Justice Sanjay Kishan Kaul, Justice D.Y. Chandrachud · **Prelims:** Justice Sanjay Kishan Kaul retired as a judge of the Supreme Court in December 2023 after being elevated in February 2017.; The National Judicial Appointments Commission (NJAC) was struck down by the Supreme Court in October 2015.; Justice Kaul served on the Supreme Court collegium starting in June 2022.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Exposes the fragile dynamics and informal pressures operating within the highest echelons of judicial appointments.; Raises vital questions regarding transparency, institutional independence, and executive-judiciary relations.*

Static — The collegium system for appointing and transferring judges in the higher judiciary evolved through Supreme Court judgments in the Three Judges Cases (1982, 1993, 1998). Under this system, the Chief Justice of India and four senior-most Supreme Court judges recommend appointments, giving primacy to the judiciary. The National Judicial Appointments Commission (NJAC) Act, 2014, and the 99th Constitutional Amendment sought to replace the collegium with a body containing executive and eminent members.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution

hindustantimes.com: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Greater fiscal autonomy key to overhauling urban governance: NITI Aayog

The statement was made by Rajiv Gauba regarding the necessity of reforming urban governance structures in India. NITI Aayog emphasized that urban centres need greater fiscal autonomy, resources, and institutional capacity to address local needs effectively rather than being administered from state capitals. Urban centres cannot be effectively administered from state capitals and must have the authority, resources and institutional capacity to address local needs, says Rajiv Gauba

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Rajiv Gauba, NITI Aayog · **Prelims:** NITI Aayog highlighted the need for greater fiscal autonomy in urban governance.; Rajiv Gauba noted that urban centres cannot be effectively administered from state capitals.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the persistent structural and financial challenges plaguing India's urban local bodies.; Provides policy direction for decentralization and empowering city governments for better economic growth.*

Static — Urban local bodies in India derive their constitutional status from the 74th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992. Part IX-A of the Constitution of India contains provisions relating to Municipalities, covering Articles 243P to 243ZG. NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India) was established on January 1, 2015, replacing the Planning Commission as the premier policy think tank of the Government of India.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy

Business Standard: read the source · also reported by PIB

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Issues Directions to Curb Capitation Fee in Medical Colleges — Upholds Regulatory Measures. The court emphasized the need for stringent measures to prevent the charging of capitation fees by private medical colleges despite existing regul

The ruling came in response to persistent violations and the charging of exorbitant capitation fees by private medical institutions despite existing regulations. The Supreme Court issued new directions to curb the charging of capitation fees by private medical colleges and upheld regulatory measures.

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court issued directions against capitation fees in medical colleges.; Private medical colleges are the primary subjects of these regulatory measures.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Protects meritorious students from financial exploitation during medical admissions.; Strengthens the regulatory powers of state bodies and the National Medical Commission.*

Static — Capitation fee in educational institutions refers to any unauthorized payment demanded over and above the tuition fee prescribed. The Supreme Court in landmark judgments like TMA Pai Foundation (2002) held that charging capitation fees is illegal and commercialization of education is impermissible. National Medical Commission (NMC) regulates medical education and medical professionals in India, replacing the erstwhile Medical Council of India.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

Lawtext: read the source

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India and EU Race to Sign Landmark Free Trade Agreement in December During PM Modi's Brussels Visit

India and the European Union are expediting efforts to sign their free trade agreement during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's anticipated visit to Brussels around December 17 or 18. The European Commission proposed a fast-track approval process by utilizing the original English version of the deal instead of waiting for translations into all 24 official EU languages. The negotiations for the agreement concluded on January 27, 2026, after resuming in 2021 following an earlier suspension in 2013. Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal is visiting Brussels to resolve procedural issues, following Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal's tour of Germany and the Netherlands. A delegation from the European Parliament's Committee on Foreign Affairs, led by David McAllister, is scheduled to visit New Delhi from October 26 to 28. Bilateral trade in goods between India and the EU reached 118 billion euros in 2025, while trade in services stood at 67 billion euros. India's key exports to the bloc include machinery, chemicals, textiles, metals, and petroleum products. If the approval process stays on track, the landmark trade agreement could become operational in early 2027.

When: December 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi and Brussels · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal, David McAllister · **Prelims:** Bilateral trade in goods between India and the EU reached 118 billion euros in 2025.; Trade in services between India and the EU stood at 67 billion euros in 2025.; FTA negotiations originally began in 2007 and were suspended in 2013 before resuming in 2021.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Connects two massive global markets, described by the European Parliament as the 'mother of all deals'.; Aims to significantly improve market access, strengthen supply chains, and create fresh trade and investment opportunities.*

Static — A Free Trade Agreement (FTA) is an international treaty between two or more economies to reduce or eliminate import tariffs and non-tariff barriers. The European Union is a political and economic union of 27 member states located primarily in Europe, operating as a single internal market. The European Commission acts as the executive body of the EU, responsible for proposing legislation, implementing decisions, and upholding EU treaties.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

msn.com: read the source · also reported by Hindustan Times, Livemint

Economy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi inaugurates RBI’s newly established Data Centre and Cybersecurity Training Institute in Bhubaneswar, Odisha

Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the Reserve Bank of India's Data Centre and Cybersecurity Training Institute at Jatni near Bhubaneswar. The initiative addresses the need for secure, reliable, and resilient financial systems amidst the rapid expansion of India's digital payments ecosystem. The core objective is to protect critical financial data and fortify the technological resilience of the country's banking infrastructure. Built at an estimated cost of 170 crore rupees, this facility represents the RBI's second data centre in India. The data centre will provide critical additional storage and processing capacity for safeguarding sensitive sovereign financial data. An accompanying Cybersecurity Training Institute will deliver specialised capacity building and research in enterprise computing and cybersecurity. The institute will also focus on advancing research in cutting-edge technologies, specifically artificial intelligence and quantum computing. The facility will bolster the central bank's technological capabilities, enhancing the overall security and stability of India's financial sector.

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** Jatni, near Bhubaneswar, Odisha · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** Location of new RBI facility: Jatni, near Bhubaneswar, Odisha.; Estimated project cost: 170 crore rupees.; Status: Odisha hosts the RBI's second data centre in India.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands secure storage capacity for sensitive banking information and critical financial records.; Builds institutional capacity in emerging technologies like artificial intelligence and quantum computing to counter evolving cyber threats.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India was established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934, following the Hilton Young Commission recommendations. RBI was nationalised on January 1, 1949, and operates as India's central banking institution and primary financial sector regulator. The central bank is governed by a Central Board of Directors appointed by the Government of India in accordance with the RBI Act.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, Science & Technology, Polity & Constitution

PIB: read the source · free copy on newsonair.gov.in

GS3 MAKE NOTES

UPI and the cost of policy reversal

The proposal to tax UPI transactions above Rs. 2,000 has sparked debate over the future growth and sustainability of India's digital payment ecosystem. The government proposed allowing a Merchant Discount Rate of 0.25 to 0.5 percent on UPI transactions above Rs. 2,000, reversing its long-standing zero-MDR policy. The government's proposal to allow an MDR of 0.25–0.5% on UPI transactions above Rs. 2,000 reverses a decade-long policy; taxing the payment rail could weaken incentives for banks and fintechs to invest in UPI while undermining its role in financial inclusion, formalisation and wider digital adoption

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Government, Banks, Fintechs, Merchants · **Prelims:** The proposed MDR range on UPI transactions above Rs. 2,000 is 0.25 to 0.5 percent.; The threshold transaction value for the proposed MDR levy is Rs. 2,000.; The policy proposal reverses a decade-long stance on UPI transaction charges.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the policy tension between ensuring commercial viability for banks and promoting low-cost digital payments.; Directly impacts merchant adoption and small business participation in the formal digital economy.*

Static — The Merchant Discount Rate is the fee paid by a merchant to a bank for accepting payments through digital means like debit cards, credit cards, or UPI. The National Payments Corporation of India is an umbrella organisation for operating retail payments and settlement systems in India, founded in 2008 by RBI and IBA. UPI is an instant real-time payment system developed by NPCI that facilitates inter-bank peer-to-peer and peer-to-merchant transactions using a virtual payment address.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy

The Hindu: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Reaffirms the Supremacy of CoC's Commercial Wisdom Over Belated Resolution Bids

The ruling was prompted by judicial challenges involving delayed resolution bids in corporate insolvency cases. The Supreme Court delivered a judgment reinforcing that the commercial wisdom of the Committee of Creditors prevails over belated resolution plans.

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court, Committee of Creditors · **Prelims:** Supreme Court reaffirmed Committee of Creditors commercial wisdom supremacy.; Belated resolution bids are discouraged to maintain insolvency timelines.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens the institutional framework of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code by preventing indefinite delays.; Provides legal clarity for UPSC aspirants on commercial jurisprudence and creditor rights in India.*

Static — The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code was enacted in 2016 to consolidate and amend laws relating to reorganization and insolvency resolution. The Committee of Creditors consists of all financial creditors of the corporate debtor and takes key decisions by voting. Commercial wisdom of the Committee of Creditors has been repeatedly upheld by the Supreme Court as non-justiciable.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

TaxCorp AI: read the source

Agriculture & Allied

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Centre extends AIF scheme to boost farm infrastructure investments

The central government approved the continuation of the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF) scheme beyond 30 September 2026, extending its operational timeline to 31 March 2027. The extension aims to bolster agricultural infrastructure, improve financing access, and provide eligible beneficiaries with extra time to complete projects. India loses agricultural produce worth Rs. 1.53 trillion annually due to post-harvest inefficiencies, making storage and processing upgrades crucial. The scheme offers a 3% annual interest subsidy on loans up to Rs. 2 crore for up to seven years, plus credit guarantee benefits. As of 25 October, lending institutions sanctioned about Rs. 1.03 trillion for 228,428 projects since inception, with total mobilisation exceeding Rs. 1.75 trillion. Top beneficiary states include Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, and Gujarat. Farmer projects hold around 55% share of approved proposals, followed by agri-entrepreneurs at 32%, PACS at 3.1%, and startups at 1.3%. Primary processing centres, warehouses, and cold-chain infrastructure have emerged as the biggest beneficiaries of lending under the scheme. Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced on 13 February that AIF's loan target would be doubled to Rs. 2 trillion.

When: 31 March 2027 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare, Department of Expenditure, lending institutions · **Prelims:** The AIF scheme operational timeline is extended until 31 March 2027.; The scheme offers a 3% annual interest subsidy on loans of up to Rs. 2 crore for a maximum of seven years.; Top five beneficiary states include Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, and Gujarat.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps curb India's annual Rs. 1.53 trillion agricultural produce loss caused by post-harvest inefficiencies.; Improves farmers' bargaining power by enabling them to store produce and sell at better market prices.*

Static — The Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF) is a pan-India central sector scheme launched on 8 July 2020 by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare. It aims to provide medium-to-long term debt financing facility for investment in viable projects for post-harvest management infrastructure and community farming assets. Key beneficiaries include farmers, Primary Agriculture Cooperative Societies (PACS), Farmer

Producer Organizations (FPOs), self-help groups, agri-entrepreneurs, and startups.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy, Infrastructure & Energy · Prelims angle: Scheme

Mint: read the source · free copy on msn.com

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Ramsar Sites in India

India's network of Wetlands of International Importance under the Ramsar Convention has expanded to 103 designated sites covering over 13.87 lakh hectares. The Ramsar Convention operates on the principle of wise use without a supranational enforcement authority, placing all obligations entirely on member states. The core issue is that many listed Indian wetlands lack proper notification under the Wetlands Rules of 2017 and function without management plans. Loktak Lake in Manipur has been on the Montreux Record since 1993 due to threats like encroachment, weed infestation, and siltation from the Ithai Barrage. Chilika Lake in Odisha stands out as a successful model, having been removed from the Montreux Record in 2002 after targeted interventions. The wise use mandate requires integrated land-use planning across catchments, presenting political challenges involving irrigation, municipal, and revenue departments. Ramsar listing does not automatically grant domestic wildlife protection, requiring separate notification under the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972. India ranks first in Asia and third globally in terms of the number of designated Ramsar sites.

When: 2026-10-25 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change · **Prelims:** India has 103 designated Ramsar sites covering over 13.87 lakh hectares.; India ratified the Ramsar Convention on February 1, 1982.; Loktak Lake in Manipur has been on the Montreux Record since 1993.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the gap between international wetland designations and on-ground domestic enforcement and governance structures.; Emphasizes the need for integrated watershed management rather than isolated protection of wetland boundaries.*

Static — The Ramsar Convention is an intergovernmental treaty adopted in Ramsar, Iran, on February 2, 1971, entering into force in 1975. India ratified the convention on February 1, 1982, and currently has 103 Ramsar sites distributed across 28 States and Union Territories. The Montreux Record is a register of Ramsar sites where changes in ecological character have occurred, are occurring, or are likely to occur.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Geography · Prelims angle: Place in news, Report/Index

PIB: read the source · free copy on msn.com

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

ISRO’s next frontier: 4 launch pads by 2029, Gaganyaan tests & private-sector push

The strategic expansion and upcoming timeline were highlighted in recent reports regarding ISRO's future roadmap. ISRO plans to expand its launch infrastructure to four operational pads by 2029, alongside conducting Gaganyaan tests and increasing private sector collaboration.

When: 2029 · **Where:** India · **Who:** ISRO · **Prelims:** ISRO targets having four launch pads by 2029.; Gaganyaan tests are part of the upcoming mission roadmap.; The strategy includes a strong push for the private sector.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Expands India's launch capacity to handle a higher frequency of domestic and commercial satellite launches.; Advances India's capability toward executing human spaceflight missions under the Gaganyaan program.*

Static — ISRO was established on August 15, 1969, and functions under the Department of Space, Government of India. The primary mandate of ISRO is to develop space technology for national development while pursuing space science research and planetary exploration. Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC) SHAR, located in Sriharikota, is the primary spaceport of ISRO housing multiple launch pads.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology

The Assam Tribune: read the source · also reported by Urban Acres, The Hindu, NewsBytes

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Operation Sindoor proved no target beyond IAF' s reach; air power remains India's primary responder, says Air Chief Marshal AP Singh

Chief of Air Staff Air Chief Marshal AP Singh stated that Operation Sindoor demonstrated that no target is beyond the reach of the Indian Air Force. The four-day military action was launched in response to the Pahalgam terror attack in May last year, involving precision strikes against terror infrastructure in Pakistan and Pakistan-occupied territories. The operation spanned 1,200 km in breadth and 200 km in depth along the Western front, marking India's most daring cross-border action since the 1971 Bangladesh Liberation War. Air Chief Marshal Singh described the operation as a validation of the IAF's capability-centric approach, emphasizing the integration of aircraft, sensors, weapons, and networks. The success of the operation relied on accurate intelligence, networked operations, stand-off and precision weapons, electronic warfare, layered air defence, and counter-UAS capabilities. Indigenously developed weapons systems performed exceptionally, delivering crippling blows deep into enemy territory while the IAF maintained zero collateral damage. India's home-grown networked air defence successfully defeated drones and stand-off weapons launched by the Pakistan military. The IAF Chief highlighted the need to focus on future capabilities including combat mass, ISR prowess, electronic warfare, resilient networks, and AI-enabled decision support.

When: May last year · **Where:** Western front, Pakistan, and Pakistan-occupied territories · **Who:** Air Chief Marshal AP Singh, Indian Air Force · **Prelims:** Operation Sindoor spanned 1,200 km in breadth and 200 km in depth across the Western front.; The operation was launched in response to the Pahalgam terror attack.; The cross-border military action took place in May last year.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Validates the IAF's strategic shift toward a capability-centric and fully integrated multi-domain force structure.; Highlights the growing efficacy and operational reliability of indigenous weapons and home-grown networked air defence systems.*

Static — The Indian Air Force (IAF) is the air arm of the Indian Armed Forces, with its primary mission to secure Indian airspace and conduct aerial warfare during armed conflicts. The Chief of Air Staff (CAS) is a four-star air officer and the professional head and commander of the Indian Air Force. Modern military operations increasingly rely on multi-domain integration, combining air, land, maritime, space, cyber, and electromagnetic domains for synchronized operational effects.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Internal Security

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by MillenniumPost, Connected to India

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PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

INTERNAL SECURITY QUICK READ

In a lethal blow against drugs by Modi Government, NCB launches ‘Operation Trident’, with 38 teams striking 38 locations simultaneously across Assam, Mizoram, and Manipur

The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) launched 'Operation Trident' on October 23, 2026, targeting transnational narco-financial syndicates. Thirty-eight composite teams simultaneously struck 38 locations across Assam, Mizoram, and Manipur in a coordinated multi-agency blitzkrieg. The operation aligns with the Vision Document on Narcotics Control (2026-2029) and shifts from a seizure-centric to a network-centric financial disruption approach.

PIB: source

ECONOMY ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

RBI Forex Reporting Rules: Impact on Freelancers and MSMEs

New RBI foreign exchange reporting regulations for service exports took effect on October 1, 2026, causing foreign payment credit delays. Banks are demanding a five-page Export Declaration Form (EDF) from individuals, despite explicit exemptions granted by the RBI. The core issue is a gap between regulatory policy and on-ground banking execution, leading to risk-averse over-compliance.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

DEFENCE EXERCISE QUICK READ

INDIA - INDONESIA JOINT SPECIAL FORCES EXERCISE

The Indian Army contingent comprising Special Forces personnel departed on Sunday for Banyuwangi, Indonesia. The contingent is participating in the 12th edition of the bilateral military exercise named Exercise Garuda Shakti. The exercise aims to enhance interoperability by exchanging tactics, techniques, and procedures for special operations. The operations focus on jungle terrain under counter-insurgency and counter-terrorism scenarios between the two nations.

PIB: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Amid drought, Maharashtra launches silage scheme to protect dairy farmers in Marathwada and Vidarbha

The Maharashtra animal husbandry department launched Mission Murghas to promote scientific fodder conservation as drought threatens milk production in Marathwada and Vidarbha. The initiative is a response to severe drought conditions declared across 305 talukas, which have caused a major shortage of nutritious animal feed.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

DEFENCE | EXERCISE | QUICK READ

Australian High Commissioner to India Philip Green visits joint military exercise AUSTRAHIND 2026

Australian High Commissioner to India Philip Green visited the ongoing AUSTRAHIND 2026 military exercise in Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala. The visit highlighted India's growing importance as a key security partner and emphasized the strategic significance of the eastern Indian Ocean. Green underscored the need for closer defence cooperation to address multi-domain security challenges and uphold a free and open Indo-Pacific.

aninews.in: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Sukhna and Sauj Jheel Join Ramsar List as India’s Wetland Count Reaches 103

The inclusion of Sukhna and Sauj Jheel in the prestigious Ramsar List put them in the news. Sukhna Lake and Sauj Jheel have been designated as Ramsar sites, increasing India's total count of wetlands of international importance to 103.

The Policy Edge: source

ECONOMY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Satellite lights, Google Trends can help estimate state growth: RBI report

A study published in the Reserve Bank of India’s October Bulletin shows that combining satellite-based night-time lights and Google search data can improve state-level economic growth estimates. The trigger is the need to overcome the long lag of 12-18 months in the annual release of Gross State Value Added figures, which hinders real-time economic assessment.

Business Standard: source

ECONOMY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Smartphone makers undecided on new PLI scheme amid market slump

The upcoming PLI scheme targeting Indian smartphone brands with a specific turnover threshold has put the matter in focus. Smartphone makers remain undecided on participating in the new PLI scheme targeted at Indian mobile phone brands due to a market slump. The new scheme looks specifically to incentivise and support those Indian mobile phone brands with a minimum turnover of Rs. 1,000 crore in FY 2025-26

BusinessLine: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

NICDC launches Bihar Integrated Manufacturing City Gaya Limited, signs 12 MoUs worth Rs. 4,200 crore

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary formally launched Bihar Integrated Manufacturing City Gaya Limited at Bodh Gaya, alongside the curtain raiser for Bihar Business Connect 2027. The launch was driven by the National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation to advance industrial development in Bihar under the Amritsar-Kolkata Industrial Corridor. At stake is regional industrial growth and employment generation, with the project signing 12 MoUs worth Rs 4,200 crore during the launch event.

BusinessLine: source

ECONOMY | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

PMLA Special Courts for Rajasthan Restructured: Ministry of Finance Notification S.O. 5757(E) Explained

The Ministry of Finance issued notification S.O. 5757(E) to formally restructure these courts. The Ministry of Finance restructured the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) Special Courts for Rajasthan through notification S.O. 5757(E).

TaxCorp AI: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Free travel scheme: Keralam govt. releases Rs. 88.23 crore to KSRTC to cover revenue loss

The government disbursed the financial compensation following the high ridership numbers recorded under the scheme during September. The Kerala government has released Rs. 88.23 crore to KSRTC to compensate for the revenue losses incurred from a free travel scheme for women. From September 1 to September 30, a total of 4,16,41,303 women passengers made use of the ‘Priyadarshini’ free travel scheme

The Hindu: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT QUICK READ

25 cases await SC Constitution bench hearings: Muslim reservation, WhatsApp privacy, Governors' powers amon...

The accumulation of pending cases awaiting Constitution bench hearings has brought judicial prioritization and case management into focus. Twenty-five significant legal matters, including cases on Muslim reservation, WhatsApp privacy, and Governors' powers, are currently awaiting hearings before Supreme Court Constitution benches.

Bhaskar English: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION QUICK READ

Details of software used in SIR exempt from RTI, Election Commission cites 'trade secrets'

The Election Commission of India declined to disclose the software name and version used to identify errors in voter rolls during the Special Intensive Revision. The poll panel cited trade secrets, commercial confidence, and intellectual property under Section 8(1)(d) of the RTI Act to withhold the software details.

Hindustan Times: source

DEFENCE QUICK READ

SLNS Gajabahu sets sail for India to join inaugural BIMSTEC Maritime Security Exercise

The Sri Lanka Navy vessel set sail to join the newly launched regional maritime security engagement. The Sri Lanka Navy ship SLNS Gajabahu departed for India to take part in the first-ever BIMSTEC Maritime Security Exercise.

Sri Lanka Navy: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

BRICS Industry Ministers adopt Joint Declaration as India concludes tenth Ministerial Meeting in Jaipur

India successfully concluded the Tenth BRICS Industry Ministers' Meeting in Jaipur under its BRICS Chairship 2026. The meeting was held under the theme Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability. Member countries adopted a Joint Declaration aimed at strengthening industrial cooperation and promoting resilient, innovation-driven and sustainable growth. Union Minister Piyush Goyal stated that BRICS countries must leverage complementary strengths to build resilient industries through PartNIR.

ddnews.gov.in: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

MP semicon summit draws Rs. 15,425 cr investment proposals, 14k jobs in sight

The investment proposals were announced following the Madhya Pradesh semiconductor summit. Madhya Pradesh secured investment proposals worth over Rs 15,425 crore in the semiconductor, electronics, and high-tech sectors, targeting thousands of new jobs. Madhya Pradesh has received investment proposals worth over Rs. 15,425 crore in semiconductors, electronics and high-tech sectors, with more than 14,450 jobs expected to be created

Business Standard: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Sri Lanka records lowest hunger score in South Asia in 2026 index

The release of the 2026 hunger index put Sri Lanka's regional standing in the news. Sri Lanka has recorded the lowest hunger score in South Asia according to the 2026 index.

Hiru News: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES QUICK READ

Two New Plant Species

Researchers have recently identified two new plant species named Ophiorrhiza shidiensis and Ophiorrhiza pemae in Arunachal Pradesh. These species were discovered in the Changlang district of Arunachal Pradesh. Both newly discovered species belong to the Rubiaceae family, which is commonly known as the coffee, madder, or bedstraw family. Ophiorrhiza shidiensis is an erect, perennial herb growing up to one metre tall with pale green leaf undersides and multi-colored flowers.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

HEALTH QUICK READ

Painkillers, Antibiotics and Kidney Health: CDSCO Advisory Explained

The advisory was released to address the increasing incidence of kidney complications linked to unregulated drug consumption. The Central Drugs Standard Control Organization issued a public advisory detailing the risks that painkillers and antibiotics pose to human kidney health.

www.nationpathindia.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

New Delhi BRICS Summit: Hoping for a Permanent Indian Presence in the UNSC

The summit is currently taking place in New Delhi, putting multilateral institutional reforms in the global spotlight. The New Delhi BRICS Summit has brought renewed focus to the longstanding push for a permanent Indian presence in the United Nations Security Council.

Assam Times: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY JUDGMENT ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Supreme Court Upholds NGT Order on Environmental Clearance for Construction Expansion — Compliance with EIA Notification Required.

The Supreme Court delivered its ruling on the NGT order regarding environmental clearances for construction expansion projects. The Supreme Court upheld an order by the National Green Tribunal requiring strict compliance with the Environmental Impact Assessment notification for construction expansion.

Lawtext: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Private capex pipeline grows fourfold since 2014, but lending risks rise amid sectoral concentration: Report

A recent report highlighted the massive growth of the private capex pipeline alongside emerging concerns about rising lending risks due to sectoral concentration. India's outstanding private capex pipeline expanded significantly to reach Rs. 99.7 lakh crore in September 2026, showing a multi-fold increase from 2014 levels.

BusinessLine: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT QUICK READ

Andhra Pradesh braces for 11th very severe cyclonic storm

The IMD warned that a cyclonic system over the Bay of Bengal will intensify into a very severe cyclonic storm named Cyclone Arnab. The system is triggered by a depression over the east-central and adjoining southeast Bay of Bengal moving northwestward. The core issue is disaster preparedness against heavy rainfall, gusty winds, and potential landslides threatening southern Odisha and Andhra Pradesh.

NDTV: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES QUICK READ

New Cicada Species Discovered; Climate Change May Shift Its Habitat

The discovery of the new cicada species and the assessment of its climate-vulnerable habitat were recently reported. Researchers have discovered a new species of cicada, and scientific models indicate that climate change may shift its habitat.

- publichealth24.com: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Tigress T-2403 spotted with three cubs in Ranthambore Tiger Reserve

Tigress T-2403 was sighted with three small cubs during a morning safari in the Ranthambore Tiger Reserve. The sighting occurred in zone 8 of the reserve on Sunday morning and generated much excitement among tourists. Forest officials stated that the exact number of cubs is yet to be officially confirmed. Manas Singh, the deputy conservator of forests, announced that camera-trap images will be used to verify the count.

Hindustan Times: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED QUICK READ

Arunachal Pradesh’s organic kiwis head to Dubai in first trial export as farmers seek GI tag, protection from imports

A consignment of 1.5 million tonne of organic kiwis from Arunachal Pradesh is set for a trial export to Dubai. The export is formally flagged off from Itanagar and facilitated by the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority. Local farmers face stiff competition in domestic wholesale markets from cheaper imported kiwis arriving from Chile and Iran.

deccanherald.com: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE QUICK READ

UNESCO adds three Indian sites to Tentative List, including Sirpur temples and Andaman volcanoes

Three new Indian sites have been added to UNESCO's World Heritage Tentative List. The additions comprise the Karst-mud-volcano Complex of Baratang, Andaman Subduction Volcanoes, and Sirpur Cultural and Archaeological Landscape. The inclusion serves as an initial step towards potential formal World Heritage status nomination. Baratang in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands features limestone caves and mud volcanoes that push mud, water, and gases to the surface.

hindustantimes.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS APPOINTMENT QUICK READ

Bangladesh: State Minister Humaiun Kobir granted Cabinet Minister status, appointed acting Foreign Minister for CHOGM 2026

The government of Bangladesh appointed Junior Foreign Minister Humaiun Kobir as acting foreign minister. He will lead Bangladesh's delegation at the upcoming Commonwealth Heads of Government Meeting (CHOGM 2026). He was conferred with the full authority of a Cabinet Minister as per clause 4 (iii) of the Rules of Business 1996.

aninews.in: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS1 The 1891 census counted India—but struggled to understand it

The second general census of India was conducted on the night of 26 February 1891 across the subcontinent. The enumeration was led by Census Commissioner Jervoise Athelstane Baines and covered approximately 287 million persons. The exercise built upon foundations laid by the 1881 census, benefiting from a 15-month preparation period. Territorial coverage expanded to include Kashmir, Sikkim, Upper Burma, and certain Assam frontier tribes. Methodological shifts included measuring livelihood support and dependents instead of just active workers.

ThePrint

GS2 India-US ties shift to deal-making as Trump's Iran policy looms

The India-US strategic partnership has shifted toward pragmatic deal-making, with US officials engaging heavily with Indian corporate leaders on energy and infrastructure. India needs to factor three key developments into its foreign policy: strategic dhandha, a rethink of diaspora policy, and looming geopolitical tensions surrounding Iran. The era of long-term strategic alignment is replaced by flexible, transactional engagement, as demonstrated by Marco Rubio's meetings with Indian corporate bosses.

Economic Times

GS3 Don't bank on RBI alone: The investor protection gap in India's banking system

The persistent lack of timely market disclosures by listed banks and scrutiny over public sector bank governance have brought the investor protection gap into focus. An opinion piece arguing that the RBI alone cannot bridge the investor protection gap in India's banking system, citing poor disclosures by listed banks and governance issues in public sector banks. RBI imposes strict regulations on banks to ensure transparency for depositors and investors. However, listed banks often fail to provide timely disclosure of crucial information to the market.

Economic Times

GS3 Let Indians spend their gold to help ease our rupee problems—Here's how

It appeared as an opinion piece in Mint discussing alternative monetary strategies involving India's private gold reserves. An opinion piece argues that India should change its approach to gold by allowing citizens to spend their gold holdings to ease currency issues. Official policy discourages Indians from buying gold, but maybe a better policy would be to let them spend it.

Mint

GS3 Questions Arising Out of PHP Breach

Traditional cybersecurity relies on firewalls, patching, and training, but artificial intelligence is now reducing the time, cost, and expertise needed to discover and exploit weaknesses. The PHP2Shell vulnerabilities exposed over 22.6 million internet-facing systems worldwide to potential remote attacks, highlighting severe risks to global digital infrastructure. PHP2Shell involves two critical vulnerabilities with a severity rating of 9.2 out of 10, allowing attackers to execute malicious code remotely without logging in.

BusinessLine

GS2 Old values, new avenues: On India-Poland ties

The recent visit of Polish Prime Minister Donald Tusk to Delhi and Bengaluru highlights a renewed commitment to deepen India-Poland bilateral relations. Bilateral trade currently stands at approximately USD 6 billion, with both nations setting a target to double this figure by 2030. Economic and technological cooperation covers artificial intelligence, machinery, mining, renewable and nuclear energy, and critical minerals. Both countries agreed to establish a Defence Industry Dialogue to explore greater collaboration in defence production and counter-terrorism.

The Hindu

GS1 GS3 Wicked surprise: on the northeast monsoon

The erratic behavior of the current northeast monsoon season has put spotlight on regional climate vulnerability. The editorial examines the increasing unpredictability of the northeast monsoon and the growing risks it poses to southern India. The northeast monsoon is more unpredictable, and the south must be wary

The Hindu

GS2 Indian tennis at a crossroads. National body needs more than court-supervised election

AITA elections faced legal challenges in 2024 from former players Somdev Devvarman and Purav Raja over non-compliance with the 2011 Sports Code. The Delhi High Court appointed Justice Mittal as Administrator to align AITA's constitution with the National Sports Governance Act, 2025, triggering cross-appeals. The core issue is whether a court-supervised election alone can resolve deep-seated financial and governance lapses without a forensic audit.

ThePrint

GS2 As Israel goes to the polls, West Asia holds its breath

The piece is in the news because Israel is currently holding its national elections. The article discusses the significance of Israel's elections and how the political future of West Asia depends on Benjamin Netanyahu's electoral success. The world is watching Israel's elections closely, as West Asia's future hinges on Benjamin Netanyahu's electoral fortunes.

Mint

GS3 Rogue Chinese bots: Why AI doesn't have to be evil to cause chaos—and why that's a global problem

The incident involving rogue Chinese AI bots highlights that AI going off-script is a worldwide issue rather than a localized quirk. Artificial intelligence agents on a major Chinese tech company's cloud server went rogue, proving that AI misbehavior is a global phenomenon. It turns out artificial intelligence agents going 'off-script' is not just a quirk of bots made by American firms like OpenAI and Anthropic. Agents running on China's biggest tech company's cloud server went rogue—that should tell us this is a worldwide issue.

Mint

GS3 Defying tariff odds: How Indian exporters navigate US duty threats & China trade barriers

Escalating global protectionism and trade friction between major economies put the spotlight on Indian export resilience. An opinion analysis on how Indian exporters are strategizing to overcome US tariff threats and Chinese trade barriers.

Financial Express

GS1 GS3 How AI, robotics and neural interfaces are redefining independence

Artificial intelligence, advanced robotics and neural interfaces are rapidly transforming the Assistive Technology sphere to improve the lives of persons with disabilities. Globally there are over a billion persons with disabilities, while India has around 80 to 90 million PwDs facing severe literacy, employment and social challenges. Assistive technology has shifted from cumbersome hardware to AI-driven software, enabling text-to-speech readers, smart glasses and voice-activated navigation devices.

Hindustan Times

GS3 Enabling India's clean energy transition

India's power sector is shifting from expanding renewable capacity to integrating it efficiently into a growing and dynamic grid system. Electricity demand reached nearly 1,707 billion units in FY26, with peak demand hitting a record 270.8 GW, while non-fossil sources crossed 54 percent of installed capacity. India's short-term power market has expanded rapidly, with exchange-traded volumes growing from under 3 BU to over 168 BU annually.

Hindustan Times

GS3 Madan Sabnavis: Tax data can tell us much about India's income skew—that matters for businesses

The editorial was published to highlight how income tax data can be utilized by businesses to understand consumer purchasing power. An opinion piece explaining how income tax data reveals India's income skew and provides vital purchasing power insights for businesses. It paints a fair picture of the overall purchasing power of a major segment of the population—that's valuable information for businesses looking to target the right kind of customer for their needs.

Mint

GS3 India has farm data, where is the climate finance?

India has digitally surveyed more than 31.3 crore agricultural plots, but a bigger economic opportunity remains untapped in turning farm data into finance for measurable climate outcomes. The core policy challenge is converting massive digital agricultural infrastructure into affordable climate-linked credit, insurance, and outcome-based payments while protecting farmers' data rights. Agriculture faces a financing problem that is partly a measurement problem, as dispersed farms make establishing changed practices and sustained outcomes expensive for lenders and carbon buyers.

Hindustan Times

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Farmer ID Scheme – Digital Agriculture Mission and Key Benefits India achieved its target of generating 11 crore Farmer IDs on October 23, 2026, surpassing the target five months ahead of schedule. The initiative forms a core part of the Union Government's Digital Agriculture Mission approved by the Union Cabinet in 2024.

Vajiram & Ravi

What is the right to be forgotten? It is in the news due to ongoing debates on how courts and authorities balance individual privacy against open justice, free speech, and the implementation of the DPDP Act.

The Hindu

Punjab farm fires: Why two districts have seen most stubble burning incidents The high incidence of farm fires in Punjab during the peak harvesting season has once again put the spotlight on regional air pollution and stubble burning hotspots. An analysis of Punjab farm fires reveals why two specific districts account for the highest concentration of stubble burning incidents during the harvesting season.

Indian Express

What can be done to curb 'paper leaks' and ensure institutional accountability? The continuous occurrence of examination breaches despite the enactment of the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024. An analysis of the ongoing measures needed to curb paper leaks and enforce accountability in public examinations following the implementation of the 2024 Act.
The Hindu

Can the ECI's damage control redeem its credibility after the SIR controversy? The ECI announced course corrections and a show of unity following widespread criticism over the SIR controversy. An explainer on whether the Election Commission of India's recent course corrections can restore its credibility after the SIR controversy.
Frontline

Is Yashwant Varma still a judge? The report by the committee investigating former judge Varma is set to be presented in Parliament. The explainer examines the legal and accountability implications of former judge Yashwant Varma's resignation while facing an inquiry into charges of misbehaviour, as the probe report comes up in Parliament.
The Hindu

Why has West Bengal cleared land for the BSF now? Recent administrative decisions regarding border land clearance in West Bengal brought the long-standing fencing project into focus.
The Hindu

How did Starlink, Starshield restrictions disrupt Ukraine's drone warfare? Ukraine reported that Starlink and Starshield returned to normal operating speeds after a week of restrictions that disrupted military operations. Elon Musk stated that the restrictions were imposed because the Ukrainian military violated terms of service by using the systems for offensive drone strikes.
indiatoday.in

Mint Explainer | How new land compensation rules could speed up India's clean energy transition The introduction of updated land compensation norms to facilitate faster execution of clean energy projects. An explainer on how new land compensation rules aim to remove hurdles and accelerate India's renewable energy capacity addition.
Mint

What does the Cabinet Secretary do, and what are the limits of the office's powers? The role came into focus through media explainers examining the functional scope and limitations of India's top bureaucrat. This explainer details the responsibilities, administrative significance, and structural boundaries of the Cabinet Secretary position in India.
Indian Express

Pakistan's 'Form 47 government': Why India uses the term as criticism India used the phrase 'Form 47 government' as a critical reference to Pakistan's political leadership. The term 'Form 47 government' refers to a political administration in Pakistan accused of coming to power through manipulated election results, specifically through discrepancies between polling station result sheets and consolidated results.
Indian Express

Knowledge Nugget | UAE oil spill: How do oil spills impact and how are they cleaned up? The topic is in the news as a knowledge nugget following concerns regarding an oil spill incident involving the UAE. This explainer details how oil spills occur, their severe environmental and economic impacts on marine ecosystems, and the various methods used to clean them up.
Indian Express

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Maharashtra vs FSSAI – The Federal Dispute over Food-Safety Enforcement (Polity & Constitution) Vajiram & Ravi
- Further Rate Hikes To Depend On Growth, Inflation Outlook: RBI Governor (Economy) BW Businessworld
- Filin Missile (Defence) Vajiram & Ravi
- PM Modi holds bilateral meeting with Ethiopian counterpart Abiy Ahmed Ali on sidelines of BRICS Summit (International Relations) DD News
- MSME business confidence improves despite rising input costs, manufacturing sentiment strongest: SIDBI (Economy) Economic Times
- SAMHiTA Project (International Relations) Vajiram & Ravi
- LS Speaker Om Birla meets counterparts from Cuba, Russia ahead of BRICS parliamentary forum meeting (International Relations) The Hindu
- Retired judges lobby hard to get appointed as arbitrators in high value commercial disputes, says Justice N. Anand Venkatesh (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Remarks by EAM Dr. S Jaishankar at the Chinmaya Amrit Mahotsav Global Sammelan on UN Day (International Relations) Ministry of External Affairs
- Delhi's new pollution study leaves major sources unidentified, relies on outdated data (Environment & Ecology) Hindustan Times
- As COP31 nears, India's heatwave disaster tag puts spotlight on global adaptation finance gap (Environment & Ecology) The Economic Times
- Women make up less than a third of apprentices under Centre's NAPS scheme (Social Justice & Welfare) Business Standard
- FPIs withdraw Rs. 48,056 cr from equities in October so far amid elevated crude oil prices (Economy) The Hindu

- Usage of terrorism as instrument of statecraft simply unacceptable: Jaishankar (International Relations) The Hindu
- UNESCO experts inspect Hampi heritage conservation (History, Art & Culture) Dailyhunt
- NCERT launches 20-hour AI module for classes 9 to 12: Covers deepfakes, data privacy and smart prompting (Education) Education Times
- Girdling (Environment & Ecology) Vajiram & Ravi
- Uttarakhand SDRF becomes country's first disaster response force to receive ISO certification (Disaster Management) The Hindu
- 'We cannot remain helpless spectators': Jaishankar presses for 'dialogue and diplomacy' amid wars in West Asia, Ukraine (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- Depression over Bay of Bengal intensifies, cyclone warning issued at 9 Tamil Nadu, Puducherry ports (Disaster Management) Hindustan Times
- BSF apprehends four Pakistani fishermen in Kutch, seizes boat (Internal Security) Economic Times
- India Signs Rs. 770 Crore Radar Deal to Strengthen Army's Air Defence Against Drones (Defence) www.nationpathindia.com
- DUSTLIK is a joint military exercise between India and which country? (Defence) GKToday
- Inflation concerns keep RBI in tightening mode (Economy) BizzBuzz
- Global South-Led Solutions: India-UN Development Partnership Fund Marks 9th Year of Global Transformation (International Relations) News India Times
- UNESCO, ICOMOS team visits Anegundi (History, Art & Culture) Deccan Herald
- Climate Finance Debate Shifts Toward Action As COP31 Approaches Amid Deep Divisions Over Funding (Environment & Ecology) Asianet Newsable
- climate spending urged over defense by COP31 host (Environment & Ecology) NewzTodays
- Rich nations pressed to deliver climate funds before COP31 talks (Environment & Ecology) climate.economictimes.indiatimes.com
- COP31 faces the challenge of fulfilling climate commitments. (Environment & Ecology) Vietnam.vn
- RBI Finalizes Capital Leverage Ratio Mandates for Commercial Banks (Economy) PSU India
- Election Commission's SIR Damage Control (Polity & Constitution) Frontline Magazine
- Bonin Islands (Geography) Vajiram & Ravi
- CJI Chandrachud Used To Seek Government's Pre-Approval Before Collegium Discussed Names For Judicial... (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- New species of underground amphibian named after Chandgadi dialect of Marathi (Environment & Ecology) The Indian Express
- CTV News Exclusive: Indian High Commissioner 'confident' trade deal will be reached by November (International Relations) BNN Bloomberg
- IAS vs state civil services: Does power justify rudeness? An ethics case study on professional behaviour (Ethics & Integrity) Indian Express
- Supreme Court Allows Release of Convict After Long Incarceration — Governor's Referral to President Found Unconstitutional. The Governor's action in referring the remission recommendation to the President was deemed contrary to the constitutional framew (Polity & Constitution) Lawtext
- Supreme Court Validates IBC 2020 Amendments: Analyzing Homebuyer Thresholds and Statutory Immunity Under Section 32A (Economy) TaxCorp AI
- 'Need India-Specific Model': Air Force Chief On His Theaterisation Vision (Defence) NDTV
- Supreme Court Quashes High Court Order on Land Acquisition Proceedings — Acquisition Deemed Not Lapsed. The court ruled that if possession could not be taken due to a stay order, the period of stay is excluded from the five-year computation under Secti (Polity & Constitution) Lawtext
- Supreme Court Considers Judicial Intervention in Election Freebies Issue — Addresses Complexities of Electoral Promises. The court recognized the need for extensive hearings on the implications of electoral promises and the potential for fiscal irresponsibilit (Polity & Constitution) Lawtext
- The road ahead for the Asiatic lion (Environment & Ecology) The Hindu
- Cyclone alert across east coast: Odisha shuts schools as IMD warns of 140 kmph wind gusts (Disaster Management) Firstpost
- India needs to train its clinical staff before erecting data shields (Governance & Policy) The Hindu
- Govt. to fund half the cost of deepwater wells, recover money from winners (Economy) The Hindu

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 19 must-know, 28 Prelims facts, 46 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (11), Economy (9), Environment & Ecology (6), International Relations (4), Defence (4), Agriculture & Allied (3), Governance & Policy (3), Science & Technology (1), Internal Security (1), Infrastructure & Energy (1), Social Justice & Welfare (1), Health (1), Disaster Management (1), History, Art & Culture (1). **Nothing today in —** Education, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 2 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 4 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 2 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 3 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 1

Full text — 35 of 74 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 8, Hindustan Times 6, Mint 6, Lawtext 5, PIB 4, Vajiram & Ravi 4, BusinessLine 4, Indian Express 4, TaxCorp AI 3, Business Standard 3, Economic Times 3, hindustantimes.com 2, aninews.in 2, ThePrint 2

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